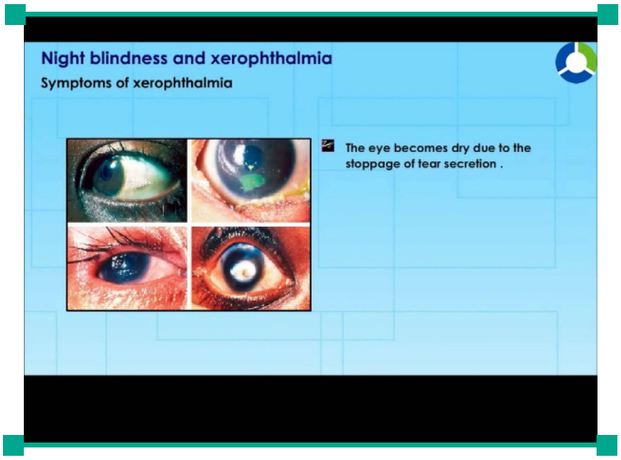
hazy and lusterless appearance.

- **Bitot's spots:** These are greyish or glistening white plaques occurring in the conjunctiva usually triangular in shape and are found in children.
- **Keratomalacia:** When Xerosis



of the conjunctiva and cornea is not treated it may develop into the condition called kerato malacia which is characterized by necrosis, ulceration and bacterial invasion of cornea leading to the total destruction of the eyeball and eventually total blindness.

WHO in 2013 has estimated 44 percent of South Asians suffer from Vitamin A deficiency and it has been identified as a major public health problem.

- **Prevention of vitamin A deficiency**
  The strategy should be a combination of long term nutrition education programme, enhanced intake of vitamin A rich food, improvement in household food security and availability of vitamin A rich foods and a periodic massive dose of vitamin A.

INTERESTING FACT

UNICEF-supported Vitamin A supplementation programmes have been reaching children aged 6 to 59 months across the globe. They have improved the immunity of children and their chance of survival has increased from 12 to 24 per cent.

Activity 2

Suggest simple dietary tips to enhance the intake of Vitamin A for school children

(b) Vitamin D: Vitamin D is known to be a prohormone of a sterol type and the synthesis of active form of vitamin D is known as the 1,25 – dihydroxycholecalciferol which is accomplished by the combined action of skin, liver and kidneys.

- **Functions**
  - Maintains balance with parathyroid hormone to stimulate the active transport of calcium and phosphorus.
  - Acts on the bones promoting calcification.
  - Facilitates the absorption of calcium and phosphorus from the intestines.
  - Involved in widespread basic cell processes with targets

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